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Home and Pushpa: The Rise Part-1 released a week before 83, and hit pay dirt at the box-office. The idea was to get in the money quickly since 83 was expected to walk all over competition. The incident not only confirmed the unpredictability of the entertainment business but threw up a more serious message—the industry was changing and at the centre of it stood a consumer who had several options, among which were films, cricket, gaming, and if the content was not to her liking, it would not make the cut.

India is, in every sense, at a very interesting phase of the entertainment story. Big money is flowing across segments and success is now driven by several factors, many well beyond the comprehension of the creators. Quality and expectations are dynamic, with the consumer pressed for time and low on patience, making the scenario extremely unpredictable. Despite that, the consumer's wallet is a hugely attractive proposition.

26 | A MOVIE ON INDIA'S TRIUMPH in the 1983 cricket World Cup with Ranveer Singh playing then skipper Kapil Dev was music to the ears of filmgoers. The timing was great as multiplexes were reopening after the pandemic and the initial films had done very well. Everyone in the trade was predicting a super-duper hit with the only debate raging on about how much it would make eventually.

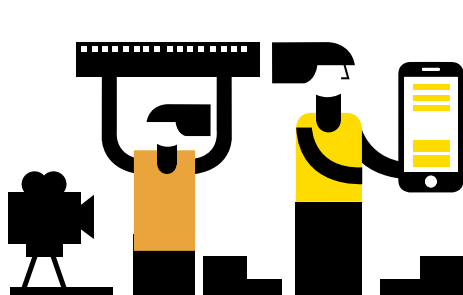
But, guess what? The film tanked. Made on a budget of ₹125 crore, domestic theatrical revenues were just ₹107 crore (the expectation was 3x more, say industry sources) and worldwide collections stood at ₹193 crore. Not enough emotion, said some, while others were clear that the current generation did not relate to it. What transpired in the midst of all this was quite remarkable. *Spider-Man: No Way*

DIGITAL DISRUPTION

Industry veteran Punit Goenka thinks the evolution over the past decade has been propelled by “deep-seated mega trends, changing consumer behaviour and a pandemic-caused disruption”. In the process, global trends have affected India, too. The MD & CEO of Zee Entertainment Enterprises identifies a few key areas. “Whether it is the consolidation of large players or streaming platforms spending big on content or creators tapping into new audiences or just the emergence of tech, the internal dynamics of the industry continue to shift,” says Goenka.

To him, the pace of change in the Indian entertainment industry mirrors global markets and he says hand-

HOW THE STORY HAS MOVED OVER TIME



1980s AND
1990s
PRIMARY
REVENUE FOR
MOVIES WAS
FROM THEATRICAL
RIGHTS AND
MUSIC

1990s
PRIMARY SOURCE
OF REVENUE WAS
THE DOMESTIC
AUDIENCE

PRE 2000s
LARGELY A
SINGLE-SCREEN
EXPERIENCE